

# Sweden Packing & Shopping Checklist 🇸🇪

For Pakistani students moving to Sweden — by Mohsin Sapra

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## 🛍️ Buy NOW in Pakistan (brand sales are on!)

Winter stock from Pakistani top brands (Outfitters, Focus, etc.) goes on sale in summer — same quality costs 3–4x more later or in Sweden.

- ☐ Good quality jeans (2–3 pairs)
- ☐ Winter jacket from a top brand — good Pakistani brands are fine. (In Sweden, Lager 157 / XXL have similar prices, so buy wherever the deal is better)
- ☐ Warm inners / thermals (2–3)
- ☐ Hoodies / sweatshirts
- ☐ Trousers (2–3), T-shirts
- ☐ Gloves, warm socks (2+ pairs), cap, neck warmer
- ☐ Shawl / chadar

## 🛏️ Bedding (expensive in Sweden — must bring)

- ☐ Bed sheets (2)
- ☐ Pillow + pillow covers
- ☐ Light blanket (پتلا کمدل)

## 🕌 Prayer & personal

- ☐ Prayer mat (جائے نماز) — very expensive in Sweden, cheap in Pakistan
- ☐ Quran — the mobile app is enough, no need to carry a heavy copy
- ☐ Tasbeeh, cap if you use them

## 💊 Medicines (very important)

Moving to a new place — you WILL need these.

- ☐ Panadol / Paracetamol
- ☐ Brufen (pain relief)
- ☐ Stomach medicine
- ☐ Johar Joshanda, Vicks
- ☐ Band-aids / plasters
- ☐ Your daily prescription medicines (bring the prescription too)

## 💻 Electronics (laptop = HAND CARRY)

- ☐ Laptop + charger — essential
- ☐ Phone charger + spare cable
- ☐ Power bank (hand carry only — not allowed in check-in)
- ☐ Headphones
- ☐ Universal / EU round-pin adapter (2)
- ☐ Extension lead

## ✂️ Personal care

- ☐ Shaving machine / trimmer + blades — much cheaper in Pakistan
- ☐ Toothbrush + paste
- ☐ Only YOUR specific shampoo / soap / fragrance if you can't live without it — everything else is easily available in Sweden

### ★ MOST IMPORTANT TIP #1 — 🍲 Food for your first days

Pack 2–4 days of home-cooked meals (sealed properly) in your hand carry. When you land, you'll be tired and hungry in a new city where you don't know the shops, the language, or anyone. Your own food saves money and stress in the first days.

- ☐ 2–4 days of cooked meals, properly sealed
- ☐ Nuts & snacks
- ☐ Small masala pack: haldi, red chilli, garam masala, zeera, dhania — small quantities, sealed & labelled
- ☐ Your one comfort item you can't live without (Mohsin brings a shaker every time!)
- ☐ Tea / kehwa

## 📄 Documents (originals, in HAND CARRY)

- ☐ Passport + visa / residence permit
- ☐ ALL original educational documents (Pakistani immigration can ask for

them)

- ☐ University admission letter
- ☐ International driving licence
- ☐ Passport-size photos

### ★ MOST IMPORTANT TIP #2 — 💰 Money

In Sweden rent is paid IN ADVANCE. Bring enough cash for at least 3 months' rent + first month's groceries — cash exchanged in Pakistan gets you a much better rate for these big, one-time expenses. For day-to-day spending after you arrive, you'll switch to digital payments (see next section). A Visa/Mastercard works as backup only — expect fees on every transaction.

- ☐ Cash for ~3 months rent + 1 month groceries (best exchange rate from Pakistan)
- ☐ Visa / Mastercard as backup (expect fees)

### 📱 Digital mindset (Sweden is almost cashless)

Daily life in Sweden runs on digital payments — people barely use cash. Buses do NOT accept cash; you need a digital payment method for tickets (some train stations have ticket machines that take cash, but don't rely on it). Start building your digital habit now.

- ☐ Have at least one working digital payment method (Visa/Mastercard or a digital wallet) before you fly
- ☐ Keep some money loaded digitally for transport tickets on day one
- ☐ Cash is still best for big amounts (rent, deposits) — but daily spending here is digital

## ✈️ Baggage plan

- ☐ Check your airline's limits (typically ~30 kg check-in + 7–8 kg hand carry + 1 laptop bag)
- ☐ Hand carry: laptop, chargers, power bank, documents, meals, valuables
- ☐ Check-in: clothes, bedding, masalas (sealed), shoes

## ❌ DON'T waste luggage space on

- ❌ Kitchen utensils / pots — everything is available in Sweden at fine prices
- ❌ Stationery — available here (bring a little only if you want)
- ❌ Bulk shampoo, soaps, perfumes, Vaseline — all available in Sweden
- ❌ Heavy Quran copy — use the app

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**Final advice:** *You're not just taking a trip — you're moving your life to a new country. Even moving to another city in Pakistan takes planning, so plan this properly. — Mohsin*